

School-Side Authorization Evidence Packet

Outward platform lawsuits -> inward district control records

This packet is built for retrieval and records requests, not theory-stacking. It collects the public sources that connect the outward lawsuits to the school-side authorization functions that can be audited.

1. Pathway and owner function

Pathway name	School-side authorization evidence pathway
Owner function	District legal counsel, school board, superintendent, technology/procurement, CIPA/E-rate authority, student-data privacy office, curriculum/CTE/media authority.
Wrong absorbing box	Platform lawsuit only; youth mental health only; digital citizenship; acceptable use; innovation; stakeholder partnership; student choice.
Correct box	Records showing school knowledge, authorization, procurement, vendor control, safety duties, and inward exposure after outward foreseeability.

The governing sentence: Schools sued outward because they recognized platform design as a foreseeable youth-harm machine. The record request asks whether the same district authorized, procured, assigned, promoted, or failed to restrict platform-shaped systems inside compulsory school.

2. Outward lawsuit evidence already found

Seattle Public Schools filed against the companies operating TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, and YouTube. SPS publicly framed the goal as changing how the companies operate and forcing them to take responsibility, while saying the companies created digital environments that negatively affect students' mental and emotional health. [1]	A district-level public admission that platform environments are dangerous enough to trigger school legal action and school-resource harm language.	Board/legal/superintendent knowledge; abatement awareness.
Reuters reported Breathitt County's school-district case produced roughly \$27 million in settlements, with Meta paying \$9 million, Snap and TikTok \$8 million each, YouTube \$2.01 million, no admissions of liability, and no required platform changes. Reuters also reported plaintiffs were pursuing similar claims by about 1,200 other districts. [2]	The theory is no longer a local Seattle issue; it is a national school-district litigation theory. Settlement converted part of the claim into money without forcing platform changes.	District legal strategy; settlement remedy gate; abatement gap.
Reuters reported Meta lobbying for language tied to KOSA that critics say could create immunity from child-harm lawsuits; Meta characterized it as federal uniformity. [3]	The liability fight is moving from facts to federal immunity/preemption. That is a category-control risk at the policy level.	Congress/lobbying/trade association immunity gate.
Reuters reported a Los Angeles jury found Meta and Google negligent for designing platforms harmful to young people in a \$6 million bellwether verdict, with the plaintiff focusing on design rather than content. [4]	Design-harm theory can survive beyond user-content framing, at least at trial level; appeals remain possible.	Product-design foreseeability; defense-category boundary.

3. Inward school-side control evidence already found: Seattle example

Seattle is useful because it gives both sides: an outward lawsuit public statement and inward policy/curriculum records on internet use, monitoring, privacy, data-sharing, and social-media branding/career language.

Policy 2022, Electronic Resources/Use of the Internet: Network Use Agreement, filtering software, supervision, and instruction are identified as district policy elements. [5]	Student internet use is not just behavior; the district has filtering, supervision, and instructional duties on its own policy page.	Wrong: acceptable use. Correct: district internet-safety control.
Policy 3540, Student Internet Access: student access is conditioned on accepting a Network Use Agreement; parents can opt out; the policy says the district cannot control all material students may be exposed to. [6]	This is the exact boundary to test: the district acknowledges access, conditions, opt-out, and exposure risk.	Wrong: student agreement absorbs risk. Correct: school-authorized access pathway.
Procedure 2022SP says the district provides network, email, and internet access as an education/research tool and reserves the right to monitor, inspect, copy, review, and store content and usage information. It also states student data confidentiality under FERPA. [7]	The district asserts operational control over district systems and usage. That control is evidence of owner function.	Wrong: no privacy/no control. Correct: monitored school infrastructure.
Policy 6501, Data Privacy: all activities involving information, data, or records must follow federal/state law and district policy; third parties with PII access must also comply. [8]	This is the third-party control hook for vendor/app/data records.	Wrong: vendor issue. Correct: district data-control function.
SPS Data Sharing Agreements page identifies FERPA's institutional service/school official exemption for disclosure without consent to school officials with legitimate educational interest. [9]	The district knows the FERPA delegation category and uses it for partner data access.	Wrong: stakeholder access. Correct: delegated institutional function.
Course Catalog 2026-27: Career Connect 2 includes internship experience and worksite learning including 'branding yourself on social media.' [10]	This is a concrete inward record connecting career-readiness language to social-media branding as a school course element.	Wrong: career readiness only. Correct: school-authorized visibility/branding pathway.

Use sentence

Seattle's own records let you ask a non-diffused question: after the district publicly named social-media companies as harmful youth environments, what did its board, superintendent, technology office, CIPA authority, privacy office, and curriculum/CTE systems do with internal internet access, monitoring, data sharing, app/vendor approval, and social-media branding language?

4. Laws and rules that make the records matter

CIPA: covered schools must maintain internet safety policy architecture; USAC states schools' policies must include monitoring minors' online activities and education about social networking, chat rooms, cyberbullying awareness, and response. [11]	CIPA/E-rate/internet-safety authority; board policy owner.	CIPA policy, E-rate certifications, filtering/monitoring contracts, safety audits, board approvals, training materials.
COPPA/FTC: in Edmodo, FTC said an ed-tech provider unlawfully used children's personal information for advertising and outsourced compliance to school districts; the order bars requiring more personal data than necessary for online educational participation. [12]	Ed-tech operator plus district procurement/approval authority where under-13 data is involved.	Vendor privacy policy, COPPA notice, data map, ad-use statements, contracts, under-13 account flows, teacher signup records.
FERPA: a contractor/consultant/other outside party can be a school official only if it performs an outsourced institutional function, is under direct school control for use and maintenance of education records, and is subject to use/redisclosure limits. [13]	Student records/privacy office; procurement; data governance; legal.	DPA, FERPA school-official designation, legitimate educational interest definition, redisclosure logs, access controls.
California Education Code section 49073.1: LEA contracts for cloud/digital services involving pupil records must keep pupil records under LEA control, prohibit non-contract use, address security, breach notice, deletion, FERPA compliance, and prohibit targeted advertising with PII in pupil records; noncompliant contracts can be voided after notice/cure. [14]	California board/procurement/legal/data privacy owner.	Contracts, addenda, board policies, renewal records, cure notices, deletion certifications, security terms.
California BPC section 22584 / SOPIPA: K-12 school-purpose operators may not engage in targeted advertising based on covered information, amass profiles except for K-12 school purposes, sell pupil information, or disclose covered information except under specified conditions. [15]	Operator compliance plus district app-approval/procurement gate.	Operator terms, ad/pixel practices, profile-building language, data disclosures, subprocessors, school-purpose statements.

5. The exact record request language

Request all records from January 1, 2010 to present concerning: (1) district lawsuits, claims, board approvals, settlement documents, counsel engagement agreements, public statements, and communications about social media companies including Meta/Facebook/Instagram, Google/YouTube, Snap/Snapchat, TikTok/ByteDance, and youth mental health, platform addiction, platform design, or student online harm; (2) district CIPA compliance, E-rate certifications, internet safety policies, filtering/monitoring measures, Network Use Agreements, acceptable-use policies, digital citizenship curriculum, cyberbullying/social networking/chat room instruction, and online-safety audits; (3) approved apps, learning platforms, Google Workspace, YouTube, social media-adjacent tools, content-creation tools, portfolio/media systems, student communication tools, LMS/SIS systems, monitoring/filtering vendors, and all related contracts, DPAs, privacy reviews, data-sharing agreements, board agenda items, procurement records, and renewal documents; and (4) curriculum, CTE, media, career-readiness, student voice, public-facing student work, internships, social media branding, content creation, and portfolio/showcase materials that authorize or instruct students to use public-facing online identity, social media, branding, content production, audience engagement, or platform-like visibility.

Narrowed follow-up search terms

- "[district name]" "social media lawsuit" "platform design" "students" "mental health" "abatement"
- "[district name]" "CIPA" "internet safety policy" "social networking" "chat rooms" "cyberbullying"
- "[district name]" "approved apps" "student data privacy agreement" "Google Workspace" "YouTube"
- "[district name]" "course catalog" "branding yourself on social media"
- "[district name]" "data sharing agreement" "FERPA" "institutional service"

6. Non-diffused owner assignment

The district sued or joined platform litigation.	Board/legal/superintendent knowledge of foreseeable platform harm.	Platform lawsuit only.
Students used district network, email, devices, or accounts.	Technology/CIPA/internet-safety authority.	Acceptable use or student choice.
A vendor received PII or pupil records.	Records/privacy/procurement/legal authority.	Vendor/stakeholder language.
A course includes social media branding, portfolio/public-facing work, content production, or audience-facing identity.	Curriculum/CTE/media authority.	Career readiness or student voice.
The system uses targeted ads, non-school profiling, sale/disclosure, excessive retention, or unnecessary data collection.	Operator plus district app/procurement gate.	Innovation/free app/teacher convenience.

Locked use sentence

The outward lawsuits prove school-side knowledge that platform design can foreseeably harm minors and impose school costs. The inward records test whether the same districts authorized, assigned, procured, normalized, or failed to abate platform-shaped exposure through school devices, school accounts, CIPA-covered internet use, vendor contracts, data-sharing, curriculum, CTE, media, career-readiness, branding, and student-visibility systems.

7. Source list

- [1] Seattle Public Schools, Social Media Complaint Filed by Seattle Public Schools
<https://www.seattleschools.org/news/social-media-case/>
- [2] Reuters, Social media companies to pay \$27 million to settle Kentucky school district's lawsuit
<https://www.reuters.com/business/meta-paid-9-million-settle-kentucky-school-districts-lawsuit-over-social-media-2026-05-29/>
- [3] Reuters, Meta lobbies Congress for protection from child-harm lawsuits
<https://www.reuters.com/world/meta-lobbies-congress-protection-child-harm-lawsuits-2026-06-18/>
- [4] Reuters, Meta, Google lose US case over social media harm to kids
<https://www.reuters.com/legal/litigation/jury-reaches-verdict-meta-google-trial-social-media-addiction-2026-03-25/>
- [5] Seattle Public Schools Policy 2022, Electronic Resources/Use of the Internet
<https://www.seattleschools.org/about/school-board/policies/2022-electronic-resources-use-of-the-internet/>
- [6] Seattle Public Schools Policy 3540, Student Internet Access
<https://www.seattleschools.org/about/school-board/policies/3540-student-internet-access/>
- [7] Seattle Public Schools 2022SP, Electronic Resources/Use of the Internet
<https://www.seattleschools.org/about/school-board/policies/2022sp-electronic-resources-use-of-the-internet/>
- [8] Seattle Public Schools Policy 6501, Data Privacy
<https://www.seattleschools.org/about/school-board/policies/6501-data-privacy/>
- [9] Seattle Public Schools, Data Sharing Agreements
<https://www.seattleschools.org/departments/community-partnerships/data-access-for-partners/data-sharing-agreements/>
- [10] Seattle Public Schools Course Catalog 2026-27
<https://www.seattleschools.org/wp-content/uploads/sites/101/2022/08/Course-Catalog-ADA.pdf>
- [11] USAC, Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA)
<https://www.usac.org/e-rate/applicant-process/starting-services/cipa/>
- [12] FTC, Edmodo COPPA enforcement announcement
<https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2023/05/ftc-says-ed-tech-provider-edmodo-unlawfully-used-childrens-personal-information-advertising>
- [13] U.S. Department of Education, FERPA regulations / school official exception
<https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/ferpa>
- [14] California Legislative Information, Education Code section 49073.1
https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/codes_displaySection.xhtml?lawCode=EDC§ionNum=49073.1
- [15] California Legislative Information, Business and Professions Code section 22584
https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/codes_displaySection.xhtml?lawCode=BPC§ionNum=22584